

Intellectual Property Rights (IPR) Policy

1. Preamble

St. Ann's College for Women, Gorantla, Guntur, recognizes Intellectual Property Rights (IPR) as an important component of academic excellence, innovation, research, and knowledge creation. The institution encourages faculty members and students to engage in innovative, research-oriented, and creative activities while ensuring the protection and ethical use of intellectual property generated within the institution.

The Intellectual Property Rights Policy aims to create awareness regarding patents, copyrights, trademarks, designs, publications, and other forms of intellectual property in accordance with the guidelines of UGC, NAAC, and other statutory bodies.

2. Objectives of the Policy

The policy aims to:

- Promote awareness about Intellectual Property Rights among faculty and students
- Encourage innovation, creativity, and research culture in the institution
- Facilitate protection of intellectual and creative work generated by faculty and students
- Support ethical practices in research and academic activities
- Prevent plagiarism and ensure academic integrity
- Encourage patent filing, copyrights, and other forms of IPR protection
- Promote collaborative research and innovation activities
- Maintain confidentiality related to intellectual property wherever required

3. Scope of the Policy

This policy applies to:

- Faculty members
- Students
- Researchers and project members
- Administrative staff associated with research activities
- Collaborative and sponsored academic projects undertaken by the institution

The policy covers intellectual property generated through:

- Research activities
- Academic projects
- Publications and study materials
- Innovative products and processes
- Designs, software, and creative works
- Consultancy and collaborative activities

4. Intellectual Property Covered Under the Policy

The policy includes the following categories of Intellectual Property:

- Patents
- Copyrights
- Trademarks
- Industrial Designs
- Research Publications
- Innovative Teaching-Learning Materials
- Software and Digital Content
- Creative and Literary Works

5. Functions of the IPR Cell

The Intellectual Property Rights Cell of the college shall:

- Create awareness on IPR through workshops, seminars, and FDPs
- Encourage faculty and students to undertake innovative and research-based activities
- Guide faculty and students regarding patent and copyright filing procedures
- Promote research ethics and academic integrity
- Support documentation and maintenance of IPR-related records
- Organize interactions with experts, academicians, scientists, and professionals
- Collaborate with IQAC and other academic bodies for IPR-related initiatives
- Encourage participation in innovation and entrepreneurship activities

6. Responsibilities of Faculty and Students

Faculty members and students shall:

- Ensure originality and authenticity in research and academic work
- Avoid plagiarism and unethical academic practices
- Maintain confidentiality of innovative ideas and research outputs whenever necessary
- Acknowledge contributions and references appropriately
- Follow institutional guidelines related to research ethics and IPR

7. Research Ethics and Academic Integrity

The institution is committed to maintaining high standards of academic integrity and ethical research practices. All stakeholders are expected to follow ethical standards in research, publication, innovation, and project work.

Any act of plagiarism, copyright violation, data manipulation, or unethical research practice shall be viewed seriously and addressed as per institutional norms and applicable regulations.

8. Patent Filing and Support

The institution encourages faculty members and students to develop innovative ideas and undertake patentable work. The IPR Cell may provide guidance and awareness regarding:

- Patent filing procedures
- Copyright registration
- Documentation requirements
- Intellectual property awareness

Faculty and students filing patents individually shall obtain necessary permission from the institution and comply with institutional rules and regulations.

9. Confidentiality

All faculty members, students, and staff associated with institutional research and innovation activities shall maintain confidentiality of IPR-related information wherever required until such information is legally disclosed or published.

10. Review and Amendments

The institution reserves the right to review, revise, or amend the IPR Policy periodically in accordance with UGC guidelines, NAAC recommendations, government regulations, and institutional requirements.

11. Conclusion

St. Ann's College for Women, Gorantla, Guntur, is committed to fostering a culture of innovation, creativity, research, and ethical academic practices. Through this Intellectual Property Rights Policy, the institution aims to encourage responsible knowledge creation, protection of intellectual assets, and promotion of academic excellence for the benefit of society and the institution.